

ENGLISH

Notable Faculty & Student Achievements

April 2026

Assistant Professor of English **Vallaire Wallace** presented on a panel at CLAGS: The Center for LGBTQ Studies' "Queer-Class Relations Conference," held at the CUNY Graduate Center in New York City. The panel was called "Queer Erotics of Class Crossover," and was facilitated by Aaron Lecklider of UMass Boston. Dr. Wallace's paper, titled "Homosociality At Sea: Hughes, *The Big Sea* and Class Consciousness," focuses on reading Langston Hughes' 1940 biography *The Big Sea* through a queer lens, with attention to how same-sex desire shadows his class encounters abroad, especially while in Nigeria.

Director of Public Engagement **Manda Wittebort** and English alum **McKenzie Rentie '25** facilitated an interactive workshop session, titled "Time Together as Ritual: Practicing the Art of Facilitation," at South by Southwest EDU. Nearly 100 nationwide participants from a diversity of sectors continued to find both facilitators throughout the entirety of the conference to offer positive feedback and express a desire to learn more from them. Attending their first SXSW, the pair was incredibly excited to build connections and community, and to speak to the importance of collaborative culture-making. Grounded in social justice and lived experience, attendees were invited to reflect on the knowledge they all are already equipped with to build meaningful connections and create sub-cultures, consider what roadblocks and challenges are keeping them from the approaches they already know, and utilize the power of storytelling as a space for changemaking.

March 2026

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was an invited speaker at a conference held at Texas Hillel in Austin. The conference addressed productive and meaningful ways to engage in religious and political difference, and was covered in the local media, available [here](#).

January 2026

Professor and Chair of English **Eileen Cleere** participated in a roundtable at the Modern Language Association's (MLA) annual meeting in Toronto, Canada from January 8–11. The roundtable featured conversation about how literature can help us navigate institutional spaces where faculty labor is increasingly gendered and generational. Her paper, "Becoming a Minor Character," discussed the temporal mismatch between the timeline for meaningful institutional transformation and a "move fast and break things" incentive structure that requires immediate and assessable outcomes.

lead a diverse group of faculty advocating for campus civility and against antisemitism at the Modern Language Association (MLA) convention. At the convention, many faculty from around the country spoke passionately about how to protect a culture of campus safety and educational integrity. You can read about the controversy at the convention [here](#).

December 2025

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was interviewed for a story in the *Times of Israel* on academic boycotts and the harm they cause to Jews and to university communities as a whole. Saenger has been a leading advocate for academic freedom and antidiscrimination. The story can be read [here](#).

November 2025

Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** presented a paper titled "Aesthetics in the flesh: Las Brown Berets and Chicana Resistencia" at the 11th Annual El Mundo Zurdo conference, hosted by Trinity University in San Antonio from November 6–8. This year's theme was "Hope Sin Fronteras: Reclaiming Fluidity, Empowering Communities, and Enacting Resistance."

Professor Emerita of English **Helene Meyers** published “Wrestling with Jewish Shame: a Review of Sarah Hurwitz’s *As a Jew*” in *The Revealer*. It can be read [here](#).

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was interviewed by *J Life: Heart of New Jersey*, on the topic of rising antisemitism in academic environments. The interview can be read [here](#).

As part of his Publicly Engaged Humanities project, Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was interviewed by KVUE Midday News Anchor Jenni Lee on the topic of rising antisemitism in academic life, and the need to support civil discourse around controversial issues. The interview can be seen [here](#).

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was an invited speaker on the topic of “Academic Engagement Network’s efforts to confront antisemitism and support and protect Jews and Zionists in academic spaces” at the Jewish National Fund’s annual conference in Hollywood, FL from October 23–26.

October 2025

Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** co-published a brief essay titled “Algunos pensamientos sobre las señoras” in the Spanish-language feminist blog, *Indisciplinadx Linguística Feminista*. This essay/blog entry provides a framework for understanding linguistic, historical, and contemporary perspectives on the identity label “señora” within Latine/x and Mexican American communities. This work emerges from Del Hierro’s larger project, Señora Power, a multi-disciplinary project committed to writing Chicana feminist consciousness into public history.

August 2025

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was selected to join 50 faculty members from around the country to represent the Academic Engagement Network (AEN) at the annual Israel on Campus Coalition National Leadership Summit in Washington, D.C. The AEN Delegation joined 750 students to learn about the Middle East and to form connections of solidarity to confront rising antisemitism at universities. This publicly engaged humanities project involved a serious engagement with politicians, authors, and community leaders, and culminated in an appearance by Ritchie Torres (D-NY).

Professor and Chair of English **Eileen Cleere** presided over her final conference as President of Interdisciplinary Nineteenth-Century Studies (INCS) in Genoa, Italy from June 18-21. In that capacity, Cleere ran a board meeting, planned upcoming conferences in Washington, D.C., Dallas, TX, and Rome, Italy, and introduced the keynote speaker, Professor Clair Pettitt, for a lecture held at the Palazzo Ducale (Doge's Palace). Cleere also delivered a paper titled "The Quickening: Pregnancy and Pronatalism in Jane Austen's *Sense and Sensibility*," and participated in a special roundtable called "Slowing Down Time: Embodied and Generational Resistances to Speed and Acceleration." Her roundtable talk was titled "Becoming a Minor Character," and suggested that the Victorian novel can help us understand models of institutional service generationally, with specific focus on the gendered and generational labor often required to sustain work in public facing (PH) and community facing (CEL) initiatives.

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** delivered a paper titled "Unveiling Hermione and Other Deferrals" at the European Shakespeare Research Association Conference in Porto, Portugal. The paper addresses Shakespeare's sense of time as a dramatic and poetic experience in *The Winter's Tale*. This play includes an appearance of an old man dressed as Time midway through its performance, and it also includes very subtle and fascinating ways of hearing temporal change and stillness.

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published “Faculty on Fifth Avenue” with *The Times of Israel*. The blog post argues for academic freedom and informed discussion about the Middle East. It can be read [here](#).

March 2025

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** presented a seminar paper titled “A Mouldy Tale Newly Set” at the Shakespeare Association of America conference in Boston on March 21. His paper discusses the path of *Pericles*, a play that Shakespeare co-authored, through its recent performance by the Royal Shakespeare Company. The play was once disdained because of its collaborative nature and sprawling geography, but now has become interesting for the same reasons.

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was an invited member of the delegation representing Academic Engagement Network (AEN), an organization dedicated to fighting academic antisemitism, at the Anti-Defamation League (ADL) “Never is Now” conference in New York City

Washington University in St. Louis. AEN and ADL announced a new partnership to clearly articulate that debate and protest about the Middle East is good, but harassment of Jewish students and calls for genocide must be stopped. A photo including Saenger and Jonathan Greenblatt, CEO and National Director of the ADL, to promote the work they are doing together can be seen [here](#), via X.

February 2025

Assistant Professors of Sociology **Adriana Ponce** and **Amanda Hernandez**, Assistant Professor of Political Science **Alexander Goodwin**, Assistant Professor of History **Bryan Kauma**, and Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** published "Teaching with Color: Thematic Hires and the Politics of Teaching in Texas," in the journal *Sociology of Race and Ethnicity*. This article joins a growing conversation in the humanities and humanistic social sciences on ways faculty of color shoulder the burden of thinking about our shared futures as racialized, intersectional, and collaborative. You can find the article [here](#).

January 2025

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** delivered an invited lecture to a diverse group of 38 academics from around the country at the Academic Engagement Network's Short Course in

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published a new article, "A Magnus Amator in Illyria: Shakespeare and the Memory of Plautus," in *Memoria Di Shakespeare*, the leading Shakespeare journal in Italy. In the article, Saenger argues that a key line in *Twelfth Night*, which begins "Some are born great," is actually an echo of the Latin dramatist Plautus. The article further explores the poetic space between languages, which Saenger has called "interlinguicity." It can be read [here](#).

December 2024

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was the invited speaker at an event at the Institute for Jewish Studies and Interfaith Understanding at Old Dominion University. He spoke about the crucial value of Zionism amidst the need to confront academic antisemitism and cultivate peace and inclusive community.

Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** presented “Chicana Feminism Now: Teaching Chicana Feminists Texts in 2024” at the National Women’s Studies Association in Detroit, MI from November 14-17. Her talk argued for the increased relevance of Chicana feminist literature and methods, presenting two case studies of English courses taught at Southwestern in Fall 2023 and Spring 2024.

Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** was featured in the Place-Based Justice Network’s November Spotlight for her project *Señora Power*. In collaboration with Dr. Sophia Martinez Abbud, an Assistant Professor at Utah State, and Dr. Gaby Barrios, an independent scholar in Los Angeles, Dr. Del Hierro developed *Señora Power*, a multi-disciplinary project committed to writing Chicana feminist consciousness into public history. With particular attention to the coalescence of Chicanx culture and identity in Los Angeles and Houston from the early 20th century to the late 1980s, the initiative tracks the radical work and resistance of señoras prior to the civil rights movement. To execute this recording of personal and scholarly nuances towards archival knowledge, the final products of *Señora Power* translate to the creation of a podcast discussing the various señora figures; a website to illustrate the project overview, hold podcast episodes, and provide breakdowns of each episode; and create physical pamphlets to be distributed in Houston and LA community centers to increase accessibility to Chicanx knowledge and history.

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** presented a paper titled “The Ethics of Ambiguity in The Merchant of Venice” at the Sixteenth Century Society Conference in Toronto on November 1. His paper addressed the issue of Shylock as a villain within the play, and how that issue has impacted modern controversies surrounding academic antisemitism.

October 2024

Part-time Professor of Creative Writing **Chelsey Clammer** '05 recently had a personal creative essay published in *Under the Gum Tree*. Her essay, "Growth," looks at the experience of a tumor extraction and the end of a relationship. The essay is the featured piece for the journal's Fall 2024 issue. The issue can be purchased (print or digital) [here](#).

Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** presented at the fourth annual La Chola Conference at East Los Angeles College on September 27-29. This conference centers Chola identities and communities, bringing together activists, artists, and scholars. Dr. Del Hierro's talk, "Las Cholas' Sartorial Scripts: A Chicana Feminist Analysis," presented part of her research on the ways fashion has constituted political and cultural tools against racism, sexism, and colonialism. The program can be found [here](#).

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published an essay titled "Shakespeare and Multilinguistic Affairs: A Strategy for Reading Across Borders" in *Contemporary Readings in Global Performances of Shakespeare*, edited by Alexa Alice Joubin. The book is published by Bloomsbury Academic as part of The Arden Shakespeare series.

September 2024

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published a blog post at the *Times of Israel*, titled "How to Spot Antisemitism." It can be read [here](#).

Professor of English **Eileen Cleere** delivered a paper at Baylor University's Armstrong Browning Library as a part of EVENT 2024, a hub conference sponsored by the North American Victorian Studies Association on September 19–21. Her paper was titled "Laugh Track: Pregnancy and Pronatalism in Jane Austen's *Sense and Sensibility*."

August 2024

English major and Associate Editor at Penguin Random House **Lydia Gregovic** '19 recently published her first novel, titled *The Monstrous Kind*. The novel, a fantasy retelling of Jane Austen's *Sense and Sensibility*, is set to release in early September and can be pre-ordered [here](#).

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was flown to Toronto to participate in a video documentary on his little brother, Mohan Govindasamy, aka Launderers. Govindasamy was matched with Saenger through the Toronto office of Big Brothers / Big Sisters, and he is currently a major figure in e-sports. The video can be seen [here](#).

Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** co-presented "Rasquachismo: A Chicana Digital Humanities Praxis" on August 9 at DH2024, the annual conference of the Alliance of Digital Humanities Organizations.

Assistant Professor of Sociology **Amanda Hernandez**, Assistant Professor of Sociology **Adriana Ponce**, Assistant Professor of Political Science **Alexander Goodwin**, Assistant Professor of History **Bryan Kauma**, and Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** had their abstract "Teaching With Color: Thematic Hires and the Politics of Teaching in Texas" accepted as a special feature for the 10 Year Reflection Special Issue on pedagogy and hope in the *Journal for the Sociology of Race & Ethnicity*. The article will be both a pedagogical reflection on hope in the classroom and on thematic hires. The issue will be available in early 2025.

July 2024

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** has been invited by Old Dominion University's Institute for Jewish Studies and Interfaith Understanding to take part in their new series, "The Nosh: Taking a Bite Out of Hard Conversations." Saenger will co-facilitate discussion on the current Israel-Palestine conflict and its impact on American academics.

April 2024

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published an essay that was featured on the *Times of Israel* website, titled "Keeping the light on, in my campus office." The essay advocates activism to combat rising antisemitism at American universities. He was nominated to join the Steering Committee of the new initiative he has helped to launch, discussed in the essay, Faculty Against Antisemitism Movement. The essay can be read [here](#).

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** was invited to contribute to the Antisemitism Studies program at Gratz College. In pioneering its new Masters program in Antisemitism Studies, Gratz College joins the expertise of its own faculty with experts from around the world.

March 2024

Professor and Austin Term Chair in English **Eileen Cleere** presided over the 39th meeting of INCS (Interdisciplinary Nineteenth-Century Studies) in Cincinnati, OH, March 21-24, under the theme of "Trans-Turns in the Nineteenth Century." In addition to whipping Board votes for a successful overhaul of the organization's bylaws and constitution and announcing prizes and initiatives at the membership banquet, Cleere chaired a panel on "Theorizing Trans-historically."

Professor and Austin Term Chair of English **Eileen Cleere** published an article in the most recent issue of the Children's Literature Association Quarterly. The essay, "Girls on Fire: Mary Elizabeth Braddon's *Lady Audley's Secret* (1861), Maud Hart Lovelace's *Betsy and Tacy Go Downtown* (1943), and the Adolescent Sublimation of Victorian Sensation" was reworked from a Paideia Lecture, and can be read [here](#).

February 2024

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** co-authored an op-ed in the Times of Israel with David Mikics, Moores Distinguished Professor in the Department of English and the Honors College, University of Houston. The article "Trouble at the Modern Language Association" opposes

Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** gave a public talk in a Modern Language Association webinar where she co-presented her recent collaborative publication, "Radical Collegiality and Joy in Graduate Education," included in the edited collection Graduate Education for a Thriving Humanities Ecosystem.

Part-Time Faculty Member in the English Department **Chelsey Clammer** '05 and had her recent lyric essay, "The Ruins of What Never Was," published in Volume 4 of iO Literary Journal, available [here](#).

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published "The University after October 7" in TELOSscope, which is part of Telos: Cultural Theory of the Contemporary.

Professor of English and Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** has been elected to the Presidency of INCS, the Interdisciplinary Nineteenth-Century Studies Association. Effective January 1, 2024, Cleere will lead the international organization for a two-year period, convening the annual convention in Cincinnati, OH, in 2024 and Genoa, Italy, in 2025. The organization has hundreds of active members who write and publish in multiple languages, ranging from English, History, and Art History to Environmental Studies, Feminist Studies, and Gender and Sexuality Studies. Learn more about the organization [here](#).

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** presented a paper at the Modern Language Association Convention in Philadelphia. His paper, "Double Tongue: Multiple Languages in Shakespeare," examines the theoretical status of linguistic mixture in the early modern period. At the convention, Saenger also advocated for social justice and academic freedom at the Delegate Assembly of the Modern Language Association, and his activism was covered in the national press. Saenger published an op-ed on the struggles of the organization, which was presented as a Featured Post in the Times of Israel. He then presented an invited talk on Academic Engagement Network's Short Course in Phoenix, "A Break in Discourse after October 7."

November 2023

On October 26th and 27th, Assistant Professor of English **Sonia Del Hierro** participated in the U.S. Latino Digital Humanities' Mellon Grants-in-Aid Showcase, a public presentation by 2023

Barrios of the University of California-Los Angeles and Sophia Martinez-Abbud of Rice University.

October 2023

Professor of English and Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** gave a talk entitled "Grooming Habits: Revisiting Victorian (Child) Marriage in the Age of #MeToo" at the annual meeting of VISAWUS (Victorian Interdisciplinary Studies Association of the Western United States) at the Seattle Public Library on October 19-21. She also participated in a pedagogy workshop dedicated to "Bringing the Climate Crisis into the Classroom."

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** co-authored with Professor of American Studies and Humanities Nancy Koppelman at The Evergreen State College an essay entitled "Before the War: Educators in Israel / Palestine" for the Times of Israel. Their essay relates their experiences leading a group of American university professionals through encounters with different perspectives in the Middle East.

June 2023

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** represented Academic Engagement Network on a trip to Israel and the Palestinian Territories. The Signature Seminar Series participants – senior and mid-level DEI and Student Affairs administrators from U.S. universities and colleges – traveled to West and East Jerusalem, Tel Aviv, Haifa, and Ramallah between June 6 and June 14 for an experiential learning opportunity. They engaged with prominent figures at Israeli and Palestinian universities and NGOs to see how people from various perspectives, including Druze, Jewish, Muslim, and secular backgrounds, are working to build bridges of understanding and how that can be relevant to improving campus climate in the US.

May 2023

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** completed a three-week residency at the department of European, American, and Intercultural Studies, Sapienza Università di Roma. He led seminars, gave lectures, and collaborated with Iolanda Plescia, Associate Professor of English in that department, as well as Laetitia Sansonetti, Senior Lecturer in English at Université Paris Nanterre, both of whom are leading figures in the study of Shakespeare's use of multiple languages and the question of translation. His final lecture was entitled "Accidental Multilingualism in Shakespeare."

February 2023

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** and Associate Professor of Theatre **Sergio Costola** collaborated on a book titled *Shakespeare in Succession: Translation and Time* (McGill-Queen's University Press, 2023). The edited collection brings together scholars from eight different countries and five continents.

January 2023

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** co-authored an essay with Cary Nelson, who is Professor Emeritus of English and Jubilee Professor of Liberal Arts and Sciences at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, and served as president of the American Association of University Professors between 2006 and 2012. The essay, entitled, "When Discourse about Israel Becomes Antisemitic: A Guide for the Perplexed." Fathom is a prominent British journal that focuses on the Middle East. [Read the essay here.](#)

Combating BDS and Israel Delegitimization.”

October 2022

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published a pamphlet with the Academic Engagement Network titled *Finding Common Ground: A Strategy for Combating the Anti-Israel Movement in the U.S. Academy*

September 2022

Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published a review of *Hamlet Translations: Prisms of Cultural Encounters across the Globe*, edited by Márta Minier and Lily Kahn. The review appeared in *Translation Studies*, a leading international academic journal.

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** published a reflection on teaching Octavia Butler's novel *Parable of the Sower* as part of the Association for the Study of Literature and Environment's Zoom In pedagogy series.

May 2022

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** took part in the symposium The Aesthetics of Infrastructure/The Infrastructure of Aesthetics at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, which was held April 21–22. An interdisciplinary group of scholars shared their work on infrastructure and the environmental humanities at the event.

April 2022

Professor of English and Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** has had an article accepted for publication by *Children's Literature Association Quarterly*. The essay, "Going Downtown: 'Right Reading,' Mental Hygiene, and the Adolescent Sublimation of Victorian Sensation," was first presented as a Paideia Connections Lecture in 2015.

Professor of English and Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** presented a paper at the 2022 Interdisciplinary Nineteenth-Century Studies (INCS) Annual Conference, held March 24–27 in Salt Lake City, Utah. Her paper, “The Stratified Family Story: Dinah Mulock Craik’s *The Head of the Family* (1852) and the Problem of Pedophilia,” is part of a larger project about the discourses of rape, grooming, and sexual assault within the genre of fiction known as the Victorian family story. Cleere also chaired a panel titled “Queer Studies, Performance, and Desire.”

Professor of English and Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** has been promoted to first vice president of Interdisciplinary Nineteenth-Century Studies (INCS), an international group of scholars dedicated to interdisciplinary discussion and research.

March 2022

Professor of English and Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere**’s article “Rape in Public: Overlooking Child Sexual Assault in Charlotte Mary Yonge’s *The Daisy Chain*” was published in *Victorian Literature and Culture*. **Morgan Mosby** ’20, Cleere’s former undergraduate research assistant, helped frame the initial ideas for the essay around issues of rape’s historic invisibility within literary and feminist criticism.

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** was featured in conversation with American Book Award-winning and Man Booker Prize-shortlisted novelist Ruth Ozeki on an episode of the podcast *Novel Dialogues*. The episode is available on Apple Podcasts, Spotify, and elsewhere online.

Feburary 2022

Recently retired Professor of English and holder of the McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** recently published two reviews of films that focus on reproductive justice. Her review of *Aftershock*, a documentary on the epidemic of Black maternal mortality, appeared on the *Lilith* blog, and her review of *My So-Called Selfish Life*, a documentary on childfree women, was published by the Jewish Women's Archive blog.

Recently retired Professor of English and holder of the McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** talked about her new book *Movie-Made Jew* on the *Revealer* podcast, hosted by New York University's Center for Media and Religion. An excerpt from her book was also published in the February issue of the *Revealer* online magazine.

January 2022

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** delivered two papers at the 2022 Modern Language Association (MLA) Annual Convention, held virtually and in person January 6–9 in Washington, D.C.. The first was part of an environmental humanities roundtable titled “Apocalyptic Realisms”; the second was part of a panel titled “The Unforeseeable,” sponsored by the Prose Fiction Forum.

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** published a review of Neal Stephenson’s latest novel, *Termination Shock*, in the *Los Angeles Review of Books*.

Professor of English and Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** delivered a paper at the 2022 Modern Language Association (MLA) Annual Convention, held January 6–9 in Washington, D.C. Her paper, “*Pivoting* and Other Words I’ll Never Use Again,” was delivered remotely when infection rates and travel conditions shifted most of the conference online. The paper was part of a panel commemorating the forthcoming publication of “Unprecedented Disruptions: Nineteenth-Century Scholars Reflect on 2020,” an issue of *Nineteenth-Century Contexts* Cleere coedited.

December 2021

Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** published "7 Jewish Feminist Highlights of 2021" in *Lilith Magazine's* blog.

A profile of Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** appeared in *The Key Reporter*, Phi Beta Kappa's online publication.

November 2021

An excerpt from *Movie-Made Jews: An American Tradition*, a recent book by Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers**, was published in the fall issue of *Lilith Magazine*.

Professor and Joanne Powers Austin Term Chair in English **Eileen Cleere** coedited a volume of *Nineteenth-Century Contexts* devoted to the unprecedented disruptions of 2020. Her introduction to the special issue, cowritten with Professors George Robb (William Paterson University) and Narin Hassan (Georgia Tech), is titled "Zooming In: Epidemic, Pandemic, Endemic."

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** and Southwestern students **Coleen Roche** '22 and **Elena Welsh** '23 presented a paper titled "Public Humanities Pedagogy for the Present" on the panel "Social Media and the Public Sphere" at the annual conference of the Association for the Study of the Arts of the Present. The paper detailed the methods and findings of the team's summer 2021 faculty-student research project and reflected on how the project changed their perspectives on collaborative humanities research and public-facing literary scholarship.

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published an article titled "Shakespeare and Linguistic Change" in *The Palgrave Encyclopedia of Global Shakespeare*. Saenger also presented a talk titled "Addressing Challenges in the Humanities & Social Sciences: Toward a Better Understanding and Use of Key Terms in Combating BDS and Israel Delegitimization"

October 2021

At the 2021 Annual Meeting of the American Studies Association, Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** presided over the Environment and Culture Caucus's professional development panel, "Teaching for Justice: A Pedagogy Working Session," and chaired and presented on a session titled "Extinction Rebellion: A Roundtable on the Performative Politics of Revolt," where she discussed both the disruptive and the theatrical elements of Extinction Rebellion and other environmental justice movements and the popular and media attention paid to each.

September 2021

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** and Associate Professor of Environmental Studies **Joshua Long** were interviewed for a story for the online magazine *Grist*. The story, "Can Climate Fiction Deliver Climate Justice?" by Maddie Stone, was published on September 28. Among other subjects, the article discusses a Southwestern summer 2021 faculty-student research project, "Climate Literature and Climate Literacy," led by Evans with two current Southwestern English students, Coleen Roche '23 and Elena Welsh '23.

Jewish culture website that prides itself on being "feminist and full of shadapany," about her new book *Movie-Made Jews: An American Tradition*. Read the interview.

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** published an article in the journal *American Literature* titled "Geomemory and Genre Friction: Infrastructural Violence and Plantation Afterlives in Contemporary African American Novels." The article is drawn from the fourth chapter of her current book project and is part of a joint special issue of *American Literature* and *Resilience: A Journal of the Environmental Humanities* titled "The Infrastructure of Emergency."

June 2021

Professor Emeritus of English **David Gaines** read his poem "Changing Course" at the Poets of the Northland reading on May 26, 2021. It received the grand prize in the Duluth Dylan Festival Poetry Contest, a celebration of Bob Dylan's 80th birthday hosted by the Nobel laureate's fans and scholars in his hometown.

Dharma College, in Chandigarh, India. On May 25, he was an invited discussant responding to Alexa Alice Joubin, professor of English, theatre, international affairs, and East Asian languages and cultures at George Washington University. This event was hosted by Haun Saussy, university professor of comparative literature at the University of Chicago. The topic was Joubin's recent book, *Shakespeare and East Asia* (Oxford University Press).

March 2021

Professor of English and Holder of McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** was an invited participant on the panel "Helping Humanities Majors Tackle a Tough Job Market from a Position of Strength" at the annual meeting of the National Humanities Alliance.

February 2021

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published an entry in the *Palgrave Encyclopedia of Global Shakespeare* on "Scotland, PA (dir. Billy Morrisette, USA, 2001)," which can be viewed [here](#).

January 2021

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger** organized and hosted a webinar titled “Terms, Language, and Translation: Palestine and Israel.” The event featured Jessica Emami, adjunct professor of sociology at Marymount University in Arlington, Virginia, and Ghaith al-Omari, a senior fellow in The Washington Institute’s Irwin Levy Family Program on the U.S.–Israel Strategic Relationship and former executive director of the American Task Force on Palestine.

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** presented twice at the 2021 Modern Language Association Annual Convention, speaking as part of the roundtable “Infrastructures of Emergency” on January 7 and giving a talk titled “Apocalypse Now, Then, Ongoing: Genre Friction and Anthropocene Literature” as part of the panel “Post-Apocalypse Now” on January 9.

Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** published “7 Jewish Feminist Highlights of 2020” in *Lilith Magazine’s* blog.

the end of 2020.

December 2020

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published a featured post on the *Times of Israel* website titled "Texas Saves Progressivism." See the article here .

November 2020

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published a featured post on the *Times of Israel* website titled "Texas Saves Progressivism." See the article here .

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger** presented "Interlinguistic Shakespeare in East Asia" at the virtual 49th Southwest Conference on Asian Studies, October 23, 2020.

September 2020

Professor Emeritus of English **David Gaines** had his article "I Climbed Up Friday Mountain and Down Barsana Hill" published in the *Wall Street Journal*. Read it [here](#).

August 2020

Professor of English and Joanne Powers Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** has had an article accepted for publication in *Victorian Literature and Culture*. Initial research for the essay, "Rape in Public: Overlooking Child Sexual Assault in Charlotte Mary Yonge's 1856 *The Daisy Chain*," was conducted in 2019 by Cleere's summer research assistant, Morgan Mosby '20, a position funded by the Powers Austin endowment. The final article was inspired by the #MeToo movement and is situated methodologically within the developing academic field of new rape studies.

Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** reviewed R. L. Maizes's *Other People's Pets* for the *Washington Independent Review of Books*. Read her review [here](#).

Assistant Professor of English **Rebecca Evans** published a review of N. K. Jemisin's newest novel in the *Los Angeles Review of Books*. Read it [here](#).

July 2020

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger**, in his capacity as chair of the section for faculty in the humanities at Academic Engagement Network, cochaired an electronic conference with Ayal Feinberg, assistant professor of political science at Texas A&M University–Commerce and senior fellow at the Centre for Analysis of the Radical Right. The panel, “Scholarly Perspectives on Jews and Social and Ideological Space across the Academy,” took place on June 24, 2020. The speakers included Simon Bronner, dean of the College of General Studies and distinguished professor of social sciences and business at the University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee; Albert Cheng, assistant professor at the Department of Education Reform in the College of Education and Health Professions at the University of Arkansas, Fayetteville; André Villeneuve, Catholic biblical scholar and assistant professor in the Honors College at Azusa Pacific University; and Ken Stern, director of the Bard Center for the Study of Hate at Bard College.

June 2020

Associate Professor of English **Michael Saenger** published a blog post for the *Times of Israel* titled "Why Black Lives Matter for Jews." Read it [here](#) .

Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** published "Surviving the Pandemic: Suggestions for Liberal-Arts Colleges" in *Inside Higher Ed*.

May 2020

Professor Emeritus of English **David Gaines** reviewed Baron Wormser's novel *Songs from a Voice: Being the Recollections, Stanzas, and Observations of Abe Runyan, Songwriter and Performer* (Woodhall Press, 2020) for *The Midwest Review* . You can read the review [here](#) .

April 2020

Professor of English **David Gaines** contributed a chapter titled “Dylan’s Literary Fans: The Economy of Prestige and Reading with One Hand Waving Free” to the conference volume *New Approaches to Bob Dylan* (Southern Denmark University Press). The chapter grew out of his spring 2018 capstone course, American Nobility, and his conference presentation in Denmark that semester.

Professor of English **David Gaines** published “His Back Pages” in *The Bridge* (vol. 66, spring 2020), the leading journal of Bob Dylan studies in Europe. Therein, he reviewed “History of a Voice” poet Bryan Wormser’s new Dylan-inspired novel.

March 2020

Joanne Powers Austin Chair and Professor of English **Eileen Cleere** delivered a paper titled “Ecopsychology and the Greening of *Jane Eyre*” at the annual Interdisciplinary Nineteenth-Century Studies (INCS) Conference in Los Angeles, CA, March 4–8, 2020. She also participated in a pedagogy workshop called “How to Teach Victorian Literature Online.” Cleere currently serves on the governing board of INCS as second vice president.

Associate Professor of English and Chair of Early Modern Studies **Michael Saenger** has been named chair of the section for faculty in the humanities at the Academic Engagement Network (AEN). AEN is a national organization of faculty members and staff on American university and college campuses that seeks to oppose efforts to delegitimize Israel; to support robust discussion, research, and education about Israel in the academy; to promote campus free expression and academic freedom; and to counter antisemitism when it occurs on campus.

Professor of English **David Gaines** reviewed Sam Wasson's *The Big Goodbye*, a book about the making of the 1974 film *Chinatown*, in the February 25th *Austin Chronicle*. Read his review [here](#).

February 2020

Associate Professor of English and Chair of Early Modern Studies **Michael Saenger** has been named chair of the section for faculty in the humanities at the Academic Engagement Network (AEN). AEN is a national organization of faculty members and staff on American university and college campuses that seeks to oppose efforts to delegitimize Israel; to support robust discussion, research, and education about Israel in the academy; to promote campus free expression and academic freedom; and to counter antisemitism when it occurs on campus.

making of the 1971 film *Shogun*, in the February 2017 issue of *Chronicle*. Read the review here.

January 2020

Professor of English and Joanne Powers Austin Term Chair **Eileen Cleere** has been elected second vice president of Interdisciplinary Nineteenth-Century Studies (INCS), an international organization. Her term will run 2020–2021.

Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** published “7 Jewish Feminist Highlights of 2019” in the *Lilith Blog*. Read it here.

Professor of English and McManis University Chair **Helene Meyers** was an invited participant on the roundtable “Building Bridges: Feminist Mentorship, Collaboration, and Coalition Building” at the annual meeting of the Association for Jewish Studies. Meyers talked about diverse forms of mentoring, including public scholarship.

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